

"We strongly condemn the attack. It proves the need for coordinated effort between the Centre and states."

SITARAM YECHURY CPM politburo member



ANDHRA MODEL

The state shows how it can be done by formulating an all-round and successful strategy to deal with the Maoist menace

If Andhra Pradesh has a relatively better track record in tackling the Maoist insurgency, it is because of a holistic approach that has evolved during the last three decades. The state follows a carrot and stick policy to wean away potential supporters even as it has come down heavily on militant extremists.

The state has devised comprehensive rehabilitation pack-

Greyhounds, was founded in 1989 by a determined IPS officer, K.S.Vyas, who ironically was shot dead at point blank range by the extremists later. Though just 3,000 men for a large state like Andhra Pradesh, the Greyhounds get training almost comparable to that of the NSG. They also get 60 per cent more than normal pay. The state's counter-insurgency response was crafted on a thorough understanding of the Maoist 'protracted war' model. Though the Greyhounds operate as the elite spearhead in operations, the operational capacities of the entire police force have been dramatically augmented. All directly recruited officers in the state, from Assistant Sub-Inspectors (ASIS) to IPS probationers, undergo training at the Greyhound training centres. They serve a tenure of just three years, and then are posted into the District Guard, which has augmented the fighting capacities of the police.

Moreover, a special Force of young officers and men has been created in each district. The norms for buildings, protective walls, guarding, lighting, weaponry and manpower for each police station and post in Andhra Pradesh are probably unmatched in the country. There has been enormous investment in the modernisation of weapons, communications, transport and support technologies for each police station. Intelligence capacities have been augmented at all levels and the state even has a scheme of cash awards for arrest or elimination of Maoist leaders.

ages to help those quitting Maoist ranks, including their influential leaders, rebuild their lives by setting up small businesses like groceries or other income generating opportunities. On the other side, the state has insured all 1,21,343 police personnel for Rs 65.69 crore. In a relief package for families of those killed on duty, the legal heir is paid the last pay drawn till the date of superannuation, allowed to retain government accommodation, given a government job, a house site besides a cash grant ranging from Rs 9 lakhs to Rs 12 lakhs.

The elite force, the



GREYHOUNDS ON PATROL

and capabilities require immediate and exponential augmentation.

INDUCT AIR POWER

Drones and helicopters must be deployed for better surveillance

The armed forces have an acronym, SARITA or Surveillance, Accurate Reconnaissance and Intelligence for the end-objective of Target Attack to succeed. This is the key mantra for force deployment, aerospace, or counter-insurgency operations. "Capabilities in surveillance systems, communications, weaponry and insurgency-specific transportation systems—both ground-based and heliborne platforms need to be acquired," says Air Vice Marshal (retd) Kapil Kak (retd). Troops fighting Maoists need dedicated airlift through helicopters for casualty evacuation or speedily inserting or withdrawing personnel. The paramilitary forces have a huge wishlist of weapons and specialised equipment like night vision devices and man portable drones which needs to be fulfilled.

FOCUS ON DEVELOPMENT

Step up investment and delivery of services in Naxal-affected areas

Sequentially, the Home Ministry wants Disarmament, Dialogue and finally Development in the Naxal-controlled areas. "Post Dantewada, the government needs to revisit each component, even if the larger framework remains the same," says Amitabh Mattoo, Professor, International Politics, JNU. The government needs to disarm the Maoists with care and open a back channel with the CPI (Maoist) Politburo, Mattoo suggests. It is pointless to bring development to Maoist-affected areas after insurgency has stopped. Provide real incentives for the people. Carve out model Naxal-free villages to demonstrate that the state is indeed serious about caring for its people. **with Amarnath K. Menon**

THE GOVERNMENT NEEDS TO DISARM THE MAOISTS WITH CARE AND OPEN A BACK CHANNEL WITH THE CPI (MAOIST) POLITBURO TO FACILITATE THE PEACE PROCESS.